MITCHELL VIZENSKY

SENIOR GAME UX DESIGNER

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SUMMARY

Senior game UX designer with 14 years in games who takes features from idea to playable. Designs the systems players come back for (collection, progression, game modes, live events and stores) across console, mobile, desktop and web, and builds playable prototypes in code with AI coding tools to test ideas early. Set up the user research process for Pokémon's Game Studio team. Strong in systems thinking, cross-functional collaboration and measurable outcomes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

The Pokémon Company International - Senior UX Designer — Mar 2021 - Present

- Primary UX designer for Card Dex, the card collection system in Pokémon TCG Live. Cut getting a missing card from 14 steps to 5; Card Dex grew to 61% of all card exchanges and helped the game reach its 2025 day-3 retention goal.
- Designed Research Missions, collection goals launched for the 30th anniversary: 42% of weekly players claimed a reward in the first four weeks, and 61% of them claimed five or more.
- Designed the UX for Build & Battle, a new prerelease-style game mode: 16% of weekly players joined the launch event, and about 80% of started rounds were completed.
- Designed, implemented and launched Pokémon TV on Nintendo Switch. Monthly active users across all platforms grew 33.5% after launch.
- Established the user research process for Pokémon's Game Studio team.

Amazon - UX Designer II — Jan 2020 - Mar 2021

- Supported Amazon's Mobile Games Experience (MGX) department, which grossed $200M+ in revenue in 2020.
- Piloted usability studies that drove design decisions with qualitative data.
- Influenced leadership decisions across four products at once, spanning iOS, Android, FireOS and web.

Big Fish Games - UX/UI Designer — May 2016 - May 2019

- Led UX/UI design on several top-grossing iOS and Android apps, including Big Fish Casino.
- Redesigned the Big Fish Casino store, increasing sales 38.4% over the previous store.
- Produced mockups, flows, prototypes and wireframes through a fast, iterative process that fed user testing.

PLAYSTUDIOS - Art Director / UX Designer — Mar 2012 - May 2016

- Shipped 30+ games to over two million daily active iOS, Android and Facebook users.
- Directed art and partnered with game designers to ship entertaining, visually polished titles.
- Pitched games to the board of directors and managed a small production team from concept to launch.

BUILDS

Independent software - Designer & Developer, built with AI coding tools — 2026

- **VitaOS:** a free, open-source home screen for the PS Vita, designed and built end to end: information architecture, interface, motion, sound and code.
- **vita-agent-bridge:** lets AI agents see and control a PS Vita over the network (MCP server), for automated testing on real hardware.
- **Gameplay Spotlight**, a GameCube launcher designed for a CRT, and **Classic Mac games** for the 8 MHz, 1-bit Macintosh.
  github.com/hotdog-face

EDUCATION

Milwaukee Institute of Art & Design - B.F.A., Motion Graphics / Animation (2011). Dean's List (3.8 GPA), Major Class Representative.

The Animation Collaborative (2014) - Mentorship with Pixar artists Chris Sasaki and Albert Lozano.

SKILLS

Design: Product Design, UX Design, Visual/UI Design, Interaction Design, Design Systems, Wireframing & Prototyping, UX Research & Research Ops, Creative Direction

AI & Emerging Tools: Claude and Claude Code for building playable prototypes and shipped software; MCP tooling

Software: Figma, Sketch, Principle, Adobe Creative Suite, Unity, Maya, JIRA, Confluence

Strategy & Collaboration: Product strategy, systems thinking, cross-functional leadership, stakeholder alignment